

Tobias Treppmann

Brand codified into a system, and a build that produces it correctly on its own

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

EMAIL

hello@treppmann.design

PORTFOLIO

treppmann.design/for/malt

LINKEDIN

linkedin.com/in/tobiastreppmann

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems

DTCG design tokens in four tiers · Style Dictionary · Storybook as the source of truth · Figma variables and live library sync · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · systems built to hold under AI-assisted work

Governance and contribution

A cross-functional working group with a documented contribution and escalation process · standards other teams build to · an exception register that sets the roadmap · change management across functions

Brand, accessibility and regulated markets

Brand themes computed from content artwork · WCAG contrast validated in code · EU Accessibility Act audits · screen-reader semantics and ARIA · localized products across six markets · GDPR plus church data-protection law · HIPAA

Leading, and senior stakeholders

Nine reports across four disciplines at Ninox, on the senior leadership team · hired two, promoted two · the Datameer design team across Germany and NYC · design-thinking training for the executive team of a listed group

PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, where the design system is mine and I built it from scratch — four token tiers serving iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source. Nobody who builds with it reports to me. Engineering sits at external agencies and product managers set direction, so the system has to produce the right result without anyone checking. The token vocabulary is enumerated, which makes the compliant path the fast one for a product manager and for an AI assistant alike. I owned the design system at Ninox and defined component architecture at Datameer before that.

One source

iOS, Android, web and connected TV — DTCG tokens in four tiers, synced by Style Dictionary

Contrast in the algorithm

brand themes computed from content artwork, and no theme can ship failing WCAG

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

- Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany*
- Brand codified into a technical system rather than written into a guideline.
 - A color engine derives a theme per artwork in OKLCH, across ten thousand videos nobody could theme by hand, with WCAG contrast validated inside it.
 - Bet on light mode against the streaming default — the brand is warm, not cinema black. In validation 87% preferred it, at 4.2 out of 5 for premium feel (n=40).
 - UI detail decided by testing, not by taste alone.
 - The engine produces two text colors. On a dense phone display one tested better, so it ships with one.
 - The token schema is structured data a model can consume. It constrains what an assistant can express, so a generated layout is predictable rather than merely plausible.
 - Scale is why it exists at all: the repetitive design step is automated out of the lifecycle rather than staffed.
 - Design system as an API — DTCG tokens in four tiers, built with Style Dictionary and platform-agnostic by design, so a new surface is implementation work rather than a system change.
 - Standardization and flexibility are held apart by architecture, not by policy. The top two tiers alias downward, so product teams get room on fixed primitives.
 - Quality is enforced by the build, not by review: Storybook as the source of truth, and CI rejects an unresolvable token reference or a hardcoded color.
 - Now diffing the production build against the prototype — code-based and screenshot-based checks on the production code, so a rendered difference is found by comparison rather than by eye.
 - Built Color Lab, the tool that tunes that engine. Thresholds, hue exclusion and the normalization curves are dials rather than commits.
 - The implementation partner builds against the token names, so a breaking change is announced, not discovered.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

- ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin*
- An accessibility law landed on the customers, who host their websites on our platform. We audited ours and theirs against the European Accessibility Act.
 - Shipped the capability that met it for them automatically, across six countries under GDPR plus church data-protection law. Almost none of these churches have anyone technical.
 - Built booking into the platform instead of bolting it on. The same build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings, and shipped to every customer. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

- Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany*
- Owned the design system, and built the governance around it: a cross-functional working group with a design lead and an engineering lead, and a documented contribution process.
 - Ran design and product at the same time — for four months, nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.
 - Half that team wrote rather than designed. I built the style guide and the content system with them, so voice was a shared standard instead of per-screen taste.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

- Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote*
- Turned a services business into a product catalog with a listed group's executive team, and ran the design-thinking training for leadership.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved across the library: what each guaranteed, and where it could be used.
- Five years of enterprise interfaces under regulation, on a platform running under HIPAA among other frameworks.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA